Local stability in structures with a standard sort

Silvia Barbina, Riccardo Camerlo, and Domenico Zambella

ABSTRACT. Recently, a classical approach to continuous structures has been proposed in [ABBMZ] and [Z] that extends the class of structures falling under the scope of [HI] or [BBHU]. These articles introduce the notion of *structures with a standard sort*. We discuss local stability in this context. We examine three variants of the order property which are prima facie non equivalent. For each variant we show that sets externally definable by stable formulas are definable in some appropriate sense.

1. Structures with a standard sort

Continuous logic [BBHU] has replaced Henson-Iovino logic [HI] as a formalism to study the model theory of continuous structures. One of the first articles on the subject, [BU], defines local stability within continuous logic. As noted by Henson, this definition escapes [HI]'s approach. This has subsequently been used as a major argument to advocate in favor of [BBHU]'s over [HI]'s approach.

In this section we recall the basic properties of the *structures with a standard sort* in [ABBMZ], which offers an alternative framework to describe continuous structures using classical logic. We refer the reader to the introduction of [ABBMZ] or [Z].

There is more than one way to define stability in [ABBMZ]'s context. It is also not clear how to generalize the notion of definability of types (in Fact 24 we introduce a definition which seems most robust). We discuss these issues in Sections 3, 4 and 5. We consider three variants and for each we prove a suitable version of the classical theorem that says that externally definable sets are definable. All three proofs follow the same line of reasoning – a finitary version of the classical argument as presented e.g. in [Z?].

Let S be a Hausdorff compact topological space. We associate to S a first order structure in a language $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{S}}$ that has a relation symbol for each compact subset $C \subseteq S$ and a function symbol for each continuous function $f : S^n \to S$. Depending on the context, C and f denote either the symbols of $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{S}}$ or their interpretation in the structure S. Throughout these notes the letter C always denotes a compact subset of S, or a tuple of such sets.

Finally, note that we could allow in $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{S}}$ relation symbols for all compact subsets of S^n, for any n. But this would clutter the notation, therefore we prefer to leave the straightforward generalization to the reader.

We also fix an arbitrary first order language which we denote by $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{H}}$ and call the language of the home sort.

2020 *Mathematics Subject Classification.* 03C66, 03C45, 03C68.

1 Definition Let $\mathcal{L}$ be a two sorted language. The two sorts are denoted by H and S. The language $\mathcal{L}$ expands $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{H}}$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{S}}$ with symbols of sort $\mathsf{H}^n \times \mathsf{S}^m \to \mathsf{S}$. An $\mathcal{L}$-structure is a structure of signature $\mathcal{L}$ that interprets these symbols with equicontinuous functions (i.e. uniformly continuous w.r.t. the variables in H).
For a given S a standard structure is a two-sorted $\mathcal{L}$-structure of the form $\langle M, S\rangle$, where M is any structure of signature $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{H}}$. Standard structures are denoted by the domain of their home sort.

We denote by $\mathcal{F}$ the set of $\mathcal{L}$-formulas constructed inductively from atomic formulas of the form (i) and (ii) below using the Boolean connectives $\wedge$, $\vee$; the quantifiers $\forall^{\mathsf{H}}$, $\exists^{\mathsf{H}}$ of sort H; and the quantifiers $\forall^{\mathsf{S}}$, $\exists^{\mathsf{S}}$ of sort S.

We write $x \in C$ for the predicate associated to a compact set C, and denote by $|\text{-}|$ the length of a tuple.

2 Definition The atomic formulas of $\mathcal{F}$ are

i. atomic and negated atomic formulas of $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{H}}$
ii. those of the form $\tau \in C$, where τ is a term of sort $\mathsf{H}^n \times \mathsf{S}^m \to \mathsf{S}$, and C a compact set.

We remark that a smaller fragment of $\mathcal{F}$ may be of interest in some specific contexts. This fragment is obtained by excluding equalities and inequalities from (i). The discussion below applies to this smaller fragment as well.

Let $M \subseteq N$ be standard structures. We say that M is an $\mathcal{F}$-elementary substructure of N if the latter models all $\mathcal{F}(M)$-sentences that are true in M.

Let x and ξ be variables of sort H, respectively S. A standard structure M is $\mathcal{F}$-saturated if it realizes every type $p(x;\xi) \subseteq \mathcal{F}(A)$, for any $A \subseteq M$ of cardinality smaller than $|M|$, that is finitely consistent in M. The following theorem is proved in [**ABBMZ**] for signatures that do not contain symbols of sort $\mathsf{H}^n \times \mathsf{S}^m \to \mathsf{S}$ with $n{\cdot}m > 0$. A similar framework has been independently introduced in [**CP**] – only without quantifiers of sort H and with an approximate notion of satisfaction. The corresponding compactness theorem is proved there with a similar method. The setting in [**CP**] is a generalization of that used by Henson and Iovino for Banach spaces ~~[HI]~~, see e.g. [**I**]. By the elimination of quantifiers of sort S, proved in [**ABBMZ**, Proposition 3.6], the two approaches are equivalent – up to approximations.

When this paper was completed, Arthuro Rodriguez-Fanlo informed the third author that a similar approach to continuous structures was introduced in [**CH**, Appendix A], though not elaborated with the same details as in the references above.

In [**Z**] it is observed that, under the assumption of equicontinuity, the proof in [**ABBMZ**] extends to the case $n{\cdot}m > 0$.

3 Theorem (Compactness) Every standard structure has an $\mathcal{F}$-saturated $\mathcal{F}$-elementary extension.

We introduce a new sort X with the purpose of conveniently describing classes of $\mathcal{F}$-formulas that only differ by the relation symbol $C \subseteq S$ they contain. Let $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$ be defined as $\mathcal{F}$ but replacing (ii) in Definition 2 by

iii. $\tau(x;\xi) \in X$, where X is a variable of sort X.

Formulas in $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$ are denoted by $\varphi(x;\xi;X)$, where $X = X_1,\ldots,X_n$ is a tuple of variables of sort X. If $C = C_1,\ldots,C_n$ is a tuple of compact subsets, then $\varphi(x;\xi;C)$, is a formula in $\mathcal{F}$. This we call an instance of $\varphi(x;\xi;X)$. All formulas in $\mathcal{F}$ are instances of formulas in $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$.

4 Definition Let $\varphi \in \mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$ be a formula – possibly with some hidden free variables. The pseudonegation of $\varphi \in \mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$ is the formula obtained by replacing the atomic formulas in $\mathcal{L}_{\mathsf{H}}$ by their negation and the logical symbols $\wedge$, $\vee$, $\forall$, $\exists$ by their respective dual $\vee$, $\wedge$, $\exists$, $\forall$. The atomic formulas of the form $\tau \in X$ remain unchanged.

The pseudonegation of φ is denoted by $\sim\varphi$. Clearly, when no variable of sort X occurs in φ, we have $\sim\varphi \leftrightarrow \neg\varphi$.

Note that, unlike $\neg\varphi$, the pseudonegation $\sim\varphi$ is again a formula in $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$.

It is sometimes convenient to work with infinite conjunctions of formulas. In the following $\sigma(x;z;X)$ denotes an $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$-type. We write $\sim\sigma(x;z;X)$ for the possibly infinite disjunction of the formulas $\sim\varphi(x;z;X)$ for $\varphi(x;z;X) \in \sigma$.

When C and $\tilde{C}$ are tuples we read $C \subseteq C'$ and $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$ componentwise. We say that C' is a neighborhood of C if every component of C' contains an open set containing the corresponding component of C.

5 Fact The following hold for every $C \subseteq C'$ and $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$, every standard structure M, and every $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}(M)$-type $\sigma(X)$

$$\begin{aligned} M &\models \sigma(C) \to \sigma(C') \\ M &\models \sim\sigma(\tilde{C}) \to \neg\sigma(C). \end{aligned}$$

6 Fact For every neighborhood C' of C there is $\tilde{C}$ disjoint from C such that

$$M \models \varphi(C) \to \neg\sim\varphi(\tilde{C}) \to \varphi(C')$$

for every M, and every $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}(M)$-formula $\varphi(X)$. Conversely, for every $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$ there is a neighboorhood C' of C such that

$$M \models \varphi(C) \to \varphi(C') \to \neg\sim\varphi(\tilde{C})$$

for every M, and every $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}(M)$-formula $\varphi(X)$.

Proof. When $\varphi(X)$ is the atomic formula $\tau \in X$, the first claim holds with $\tilde{C} = S \smallsetminus O$ where O is any open set $C \subseteq O \subseteq C'$. The second claim holds when C' is any neighborhood of C disjoint from $\tilde{C}$. Induction on the syntax of $\varphi(X)$ proves the general case. □

The above fact has the following useful consequence.

7 Fact The following are equivalent for every standard structure M, every $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}(M)$-type $\sigma(X)$, and every C

1. $M \models \sigma(C) \leftarrow \bigwedge\Big\{\sigma(C') : C' \text{ neighborhood of } C\Big\}$
2. $M \models \neg\sigma(C) \rightarrow \bigvee\Big\{\sim\sigma(\tilde{C}) : \tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing\Big\}$.

(The converse implications are trivial – therefore not displayed.)

8 Fact The equivalent conditions in Fact 7 hold in all $\mathcal{F}$-saturated structures.

Proof. It suffices to prove the claim for formulas. We prove the first of the two implications by induction on the syntax of $\varphi(X)$. The existential quantifiers of sort H and S are the only cases that require attention. Assume inductively that

$$\bigwedge\Big\{\varphi(a;C') : C' \text{ neighborhood of } C\Big\} \rightarrow \varphi(a;C)$$

holds for every $\varphi(a;C)$. Then induction for the existential quantifier follows from

$$\bigwedge\Big\{\exists x\,\varphi(x;C') : C' \text{ neighborhood of } C\Big\} \rightarrow \exists x \bigwedge\Big\{\varphi(x;C') : C' \text{ neighborhood of } C\Big\}$$

which is a consequence of saturation and the fact that if C', C'' are compact neighbourhoods of C then $\exists x\,\varphi(x;C' \cap C'')$ is satisfiable. The proof for the existential quantifier of sort S is similar. □

We say that M is $\mathcal{F}$-maximal if it models $\varphi \in \mathcal{F}(M)$ whenever φ holds in some $\mathcal{F}$-elementary extensions of M. By Fact 8 and the following fact, all $\mathcal{F}$-saturated standard structures are $\mathcal{F}$-maximal.

9 Fact Let M be a standard structure. Then the following are equivalent

1. M is $\mathcal{F}$-maximal
2. the conditions in Fact 7 hold for every type (equivalently, for every formula).

Proof. 1⇒2. If (2) in Fact 7 fails, $\neg\varphi(C) \wedge \neg\sim\varphi(\tilde{C})$ holds in M for every $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an $\mathcal{F}$-saturated $\mathcal{F}$-elementary extension of M. As M is $\mathcal{F}$-maximal, $\neg\varphi(C) \wedge \neg\sim\varphi(\tilde{C})$ also holds in $\mathcal{U}$. Then (2) in Fact 7 fails in $\mathcal{U}$, contradicting Fact 8.

2⇒1. Let N be any $\mathcal{F}$-elementary extension of M. Suppose $N \models \varphi(C)$. By (2), it suffices to prove that $M \models \varphi(C')$ for every neighborhood C' of C. Suppose not. Then, by (2) in Fact 7, $M \models \sim\varphi(\tilde{C})$ for some $\tilde{C} \cap C' = \varnothing$. Then $N \models \sim\varphi(\tilde{C})$ by $\mathcal{F}$-elementarity. As $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$, this contradicts Fact 5. □

10 Notation In what follows we work in a fixed $\mathcal{F}$-saturated standard structure $\mathcal{U}$. We denote by κ the cardinality of $\mathcal{U}$. We assume that κ is a Ramsey cardinal larger than the cardinality of the language. However, the willing reader may check that we can do without large cardinals by careful application of the Erdős-Rado Theorem, see [TZ, Appendix C.3].

In the following $\sigma(x;z;X)$ always denotes an $\mathcal{F}_X(\mathcal{U})$-type of small (i.e. $<\kappa$) cardinality.

2. A duality in $K(S)$

In this section we introduce some notions that are used to describe global types in Section 4.

Write $K(S)$ for the set of compact subsets of S. In this section $\mathcal{D}$ and $\mathcal{C}$ range over subsets of $K(S)$. We define

$$\sim\mathcal{D} \quad = \quad \{\tilde{C} \,:\, \tilde{C}\cap C \neq \varnothing \text{ for every } C\in\mathcal{D}\}.$$

Above we read $\tilde{C}\cap C\neq\varnothing$ as the negation of $\tilde{C}\cap C=\varnothing$. That is, some components of the tuples $\tilde{C}$ and C have nonempty intersection.

The following fact motivates the definition.

11 Fact Let $\mathcal{D}=\{C : \varphi(C)\}$. Then $\sim\mathcal{D}=\{\tilde{C} : \sim\varphi(\tilde{C})\}$.

Proof. We need to prove that

$$\sim\varphi(\tilde{C}) \quad\Leftrightarrow\quad \text{for every } C, \text{ if } C\cap\tilde{C}=\varnothing \text{ then } \neg\varphi(C).$$

The implication $\Rightarrow$ follows immediately from Fact 5. To prove $\Leftarrow$ assume the r.h.s. Then $\neg\varphi(S\smallsetminus O)$ holds for every open set $O\supseteq\tilde{C}$. From the second implication in Fact 7 we obtain $\sim\varphi(\tilde{C}')$ for some $\tilde{C}\subseteq\tilde{C}'\subseteq O$. As O is arbitrary, we obtain $\sim\varphi(\tilde{C})$ from the first implication in Fact 7. □

We prove some straightforward inclusions.

12 Fact For every $\mathcal{D}\subseteq\mathcal{C}$ we have $\sim\mathcal{C}\subseteq\sim\mathcal{D}$. Moreover, $\mathcal{D}\subseteq\sim\sim\mathcal{D}$.

Proof. Let $C\notin\sim\mathcal{D}$. Then $\tilde{C}\cap C=\varnothing$ for some $\tilde{C}\in\mathcal{D}$. As $\tilde{C}\in\mathcal{C}$ we conclude that $C\notin\sim\mathcal{C}$. For the second claim, let $C\notin\sim\sim\mathcal{D}$. Then $\tilde{C}\cap C=\varnothing$ for some $\tilde{C}\in\sim\mathcal{D}$. Then $C\notin\mathcal{D}$ follows. □

13 Fact For every $\mathcal{D}$ the following are equivalent

1. $\mathcal{D}=\sim\sim\mathcal{D}$.
2. $\mathcal{D}=\sim\mathcal{C}$ for some $\mathcal{C}$.

Proof. Only 2⇒1 requires a proof. From Fact 12 we obtain $\sim\sim\sim\mathcal{C}\subseteq\sim\mathcal{C}$. Assume (2). Then $\sim\sim\mathcal{D}\subseteq\mathcal{D}$ which, again by Fact 12, suffices to prove (1). □

We say that $\mathcal{D}$ is involutive if $\mathcal{D} = {\sim}{\sim}\mathcal{D}$.

14 Theorem The following are equivalent

1. $\mathcal{D}$ is involutive
2. $$C \in \mathcal{D} \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad C' \in \mathcal{D} \text{ for every neighborhood } C' \text{ of } C.$$

It is not difficult to see that (2) holds if and only if $\mathcal{D}$ is closed in the product of Vietoris topologies and includes all the supersets of its elements.

Proof. 2⇒1. By Fact 12 it suffices to prove ${\sim}{\sim}\mathcal{D} \subseteq \mathcal{D}$. Let $C \in {\sim}{\sim}\mathcal{D}$. Let O be a tuple of open sets containing C componentwise. Let $\tilde{C}$ be the componentwise complement of O. Then $\tilde{C} \notin {\sim}\mathcal{D}$. As ${\sim}\mathcal{D} = \{\tilde{C} : \hat{C} \cap \tilde{C} \neq \varnothing \text{ for every } \hat{C} \in \mathcal{D}\}$, we have that $\hat{C} \in \mathcal{D}$ for some $\hat{C} \subseteq O$. Assume (2). Then, by ⇒ every $C' \supseteq O$ is in $\mathcal{D}$. As O is arbitrary, $C \in \mathcal{D}$ by ⇐.

1⇒2. It suffices to show that (2) holds with ${\sim}\mathcal{D}$ for $\mathcal{D}$. The implication ⇒ in (2) is obvious. To prove ⇐, assume $C \notin {\sim}\mathcal{D}$. Then $C \cap \tilde{C} = \varnothing$ for some $\tilde{C} \in \mathcal{D}$. Let C' be a neighboorhood of C disjoint from $\tilde{C}$. Then the r.h.s. of the equivalence fails for C'. □

3. Stable formulas – the finitary case

In this section we consider the strongest possible notion of order property. It is not the most interesting one, but it is very similar to the classical definition – the comparison may be useful, though not stricly required for the sequel.

The following definition of stability is the classical one. We dub it *finitary* for the reason explained below.

15 Definition Let $\varphi(x;z;X)$, for x and z tuples of variables of sort H, be an $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$-formula. Let C be a fixed tuple of compact sets. We say that $\varphi(x;z;C)$ is finitarily unstable if for every $m < \omega$ there is a sequence $\langle a_i; b_i \,:\, i < m\rangle$ such that

1. $$\varphi(a_n;b_i;C) \quad \wedge \quad \neg\varphi(a_i;b_n;C) \qquad \text{for every } i < n < m.$$

A formula is finitary stable if it is not finitarily unstable.

The following is an equivalent definition which only mentions formulas in $\mathcal{F}$. The reader may wish to compare it with Definition 20.

16 Fact The following are equivalent

1. $\varphi(x;z;C)$ is finitarily stable
2. for some m there is no sequence $\langle a_i; b_i \,:\, i < m\rangle$ such that for some $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$
$$\varphi(a_n;b_i;C) \quad \wedge \quad {\sim}\varphi(a_i;b_n;\tilde{C}) \qquad \text{for every } i < n < m.$$

Proof. 1⇒2. By Fact 5.

2⇒1. Negate (1). Let $\langle a_i; b_i \,:\, i < m\rangle$ be such that (1) of Definition 15 holds. By Fact 7 there are $\tilde{C}_{n,i} \cap C = \varnothing$ such that

$$\varphi(a_n; b_i; C) \quad \wedge \quad \sim\varphi(a_i; b_n; \tilde{C}_{n,i}) \qquad\qquad \text{for every } i < n < m.$$

Then the union of the $\tilde{C}_{n,i}$ is the set $\tilde{C}$ required to negate (2). □

In a classical context, i.e. relying on $\mathcal{L}$-saturation, one can replace m in Definition 15 by ω. But this may not be true if we only have $\mathcal{F}$-saturation. Therefore we dedicate a separate section to the non-finitary version of stability.

The following definitions are classical, i.e. they rely on the full language $\mathcal{L}$.

17 Definition For a given C, a global $\varphi(x; z; C)$-type is a maximally (finitely) consistent set of formulas of the form $\varphi(x; b; C)$ or $\neg\varphi(x; b; C)$ for some $b \in \mathcal{U}^z$.

Global $\varphi(x; z; C)$-types should not be confused with global $\varphi(x; z; X)$-types which are introduced in the following section.

In this section the symbol $\mathcal{D}$ always denotes a subset of $\mathcal{U}^z$.

18 Definition We say that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\varphi(x; z; C)$ if for every finite $B \subseteq \mathcal{U}^z$ there is an $a \in \mathcal{U}^x$ such that

$$b \in \mathcal{D} \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \varphi(a; b; C) \qquad\qquad \text{for every } b \in B.$$

It goes without saying that these definitions describe two sides of the same coin. In fact, it is clear that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\varphi(x; z; C)$ if and only if

$$p(x) \quad = \quad \big\{\varphi(x; b; C) \,:\, b \in \mathcal{D}\big\} \;\cup\; \big\{\neg\varphi(x; b; C) \,:\, b \notin \mathcal{D}\big\}$$

is a global $\varphi(x; z; C)$-type.

The following theorem is often rephrased by saying that, when $\varphi(x; z; C)$ is finitarily stable, all global $\varphi(x; z; C)$-types are definable. The proof of the classical case applies verbatim because no saturation is required. We only state it here for comparison with its non-finitary counterpart, Theorem 26, and its approximate counterpart, Theorem 31.

19 Theorem Let $\varphi(x; z; C)$ be finitarily stable. Let $\mathcal{D}$ be approximable by $\varphi(x; z; C)$. Then there are some $\langle a_{i,j} \,:\, i < k,\ j < m\rangle$ such that for every $b \in \mathcal{U}^z$

$$b \in \mathcal{D} \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \bigvee_{i<k} \bigwedge_{j<m} \varphi(a_{i,j}; b; C).$$

4. Stable formulas – the non-finitary case

We discuss a version of stability that seems more appropriate in our context. There are a few differences with the previous section. First, here the attribute *stable* refers to a whole class of formulas – all instances of some $\varphi(x; z; X)$. Furthermore, the sequence

witnessing the order property is required to be infinite. Finally, since we need to extend the definition of stability to types, sequences of length κ (the cardinality of $\mathcal{U}$, a Ramsey cardinal) are used.

In this section $\mathcal{D}$ is always a subset of $\mathcal{U}^z \times K(S)^{|X|}$. We write $\sim\mathcal{D}$ for the set obtained by applying the definition in Section 2 to all fibers of $\mathcal{D}$. That is, if $\mathcal{D}_b$ is the b-fiber $\{C : \langle b; C\rangle \in \mathcal{D}\}$, we define

$$\sim\mathcal{D} \quad = \quad \bigcup_{b\in\mathcal{U}^z} \{b\} \times (\sim\mathcal{D}_b).$$

We say that $\mathcal{D}$ is involutive if all its fibers are.

20 Definition Let x and z be tuples of variables of sort H. Recall that $\sigma(x;z;X)$ always denotes a small $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}(\mathcal{U})$-type.

We say that $\sigma(x;z;X)$ is unstable if there are a sequence $\langle a_i; b_i \ : \ i<\kappa\rangle$, some C, and some $\tilde{C}\cap C=\varnothing$ such that

$$\sigma(a_n;b_i;C) \quad \wedge \quad \sim\sigma(a_i;b_n;\tilde{C}) \qquad \text{for every } i<n<\kappa \text{ or for every } n<i<\kappa.$$

A type is stable if it is not unstable.

By saturation, when $\sigma(x;z;X)$ is a formula we can replace κ with ω in the previous definition

21 Definition Let $\varphi(x;z;X)$ be an $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$-formula. A global $\varphi(x;z;X)$-type is a maximally (finitely) consistent set of formulas of the form $\varphi(x;b;C)$ or $\sim\varphi(x;b;C)$ for some $b\in\mathcal{U}^z$ and some C.

It is convenient to have a different characterization of global types, therefore the following definition.

22 Definition We say that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\sigma(x;z;X)$ if for every small set $B\subseteq\mathcal{U}^z$ there is an $a\in\mathcal{U}^x$ such that

1. $\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \ \Rightarrow\ \sigma(a;b;C)$ and
2. $\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \ \Leftarrow\ \sigma(a;b;C)$ for every $b\in B$ and every C.

When $\sigma(x;z;X)$ is a formula and $\mathcal{D}$ is involutive (2) in the above definition can be rephrased in a more convenient form.

23 Remark If $\mathcal{D}$ is involutive, the following are equivalent

2. $\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \ \Leftarrow\ \varphi(a;b;C)$
2′ $\langle b,C\rangle\in\sim\mathcal{D} \ \Rightarrow\ \sim\varphi(a;b;C)$.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{C} = \{\langle b, C\rangle : \varphi(a, b, C)\}$. This is also an involutive set by Fact 11. Then (2) says $\mathcal{C} \subseteq \mathcal{D}$. By Fact 12 this is equivalent to $\sim\mathcal{D} \subseteq \sim\mathcal{C}$ which in turn is equivalent to (2′), again by Fact 11. □

Under the assumptions of the remark (i.e. when $\mathcal{D}$ is involutive and $\sigma(x; z; X)$ is a formula), it is easy to verify by saturation that in Definition 22 the requirement *for every small B* can be replaced by *for every finite B* (indeed, one can verify that the proof of the following fact also works when B is required to be finite).

24 Fact Let $\varphi(x; z; X)$ be an $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$-formula. For every involutive $\mathcal{D}$ the following are equivalent

1. $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\varphi(x; z; X)$
2. the following is a global $\varphi(x; z; X)$-type

$$\begin{aligned} p(x) \;=\; & \big\{\ \varphi(x; b; C) : \langle b, C\rangle \in \mathcal{D}\big\} \cup \\ & \big\{\sim\varphi(x; b; C) : \langle b, C\rangle \in \sim\mathcal{D}\big\}. \end{aligned}$$

Proof. 2⇒1. Let B be a given small subset of $\mathcal{U}^z$. The consistency of $p(x) \restriction B$ provides some a such that

$$\begin{aligned} \langle b, C\rangle \in \mathcal{D} \;&\Rightarrow\; \varphi(a; b; C) \quad \text{and} \\ \langle b, C\rangle \in \sim\mathcal{D} \;&\Rightarrow\; \sim\varphi(a; b; C) \qquad\qquad \text{for every } b \in B \text{ and every } C. \end{aligned}$$

By Remark 23, these yield (1) and (2) in Definition 22.

1⇒2. First we prove that any $p(x)$ defined as in (2) is maximal whenever it is consistent – in fact, this only depends on $\mathcal{D}$ being involutive. We need to consider two cases. First, assume that $\varphi(x; b; C)$ is consistent with $p(x)$. Then consistency implies that $\langle b, \tilde{C}\rangle \notin \sim\mathcal{D}$ for every $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$. But this implies that $\langle b, C\rangle \in \sim\sim\mathcal{D} = \mathcal{D}$, therefore $\varphi(x; b; C) \in p$. The second case is when $\sim\varphi(x; b; C)$ is consistent with $p(x)$. This implies that $\langle b, \tilde{C}\rangle \notin \mathcal{D}$ for every $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$. Then $\langle b, C\rangle \in \sim\mathcal{D}$, therefore $\sim\varphi(x; b; C) \in p$.

Finally, to prove consistency, let B be a given small set. Let a be as in Definition 22. Then $a \models p(x) \restriction B$ by Remark 23. □

The proof of the main theorem of this section requires the following notion of approximation. The definition is inspired by the classical notion of approximation from below in [Z15] where it is used as rephrasing of the notion of *honest definability* in [CS]. Here this notion plays a purely technical role, but we present it as potentially interesting in its own right.

25 Definition We say that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\sigma(x; z; X)$ from below if for every small set $B \subseteq \mathcal{U}^z$ there is an $a \in \mathcal{U}^x$ such that for every C

1. $\langle b, C\rangle \in \mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \sigma(a; b; C)$ for every $b \in B$ and
2. $\langle b, C\rangle \in \mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \sigma(a; b; C)$ for every $b \in \mathcal{U}^z$.

26 Theorem Let $\sigma(x;z;X)$ be stable. Assume that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\sigma(x;z;X)$. Then there are some $\langle a_{i,j} : i,j<\lambda\rangle$ such that for every $b\in\mathcal{U}^z$ and every C

$$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Leftrightarrow\; \bigvee_{i<\lambda}\bigwedge_{j<\lambda}\sigma(a_{i,j};b;C).$$

Proof. The theorem is an immediate consequence of the following three lemmas. □

27 Lemma Let $\sigma(x;z;X)$ be stable. Assume that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\sigma(x;z;X)$ from below. Then there are some $\langle a_i : i<\lambda\rangle$ such that for every $b\in\mathcal{U}^z$ and every C

1. $$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \bigvee_{i<\lambda}\sigma(a_i;b;C)$$
2. $$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \bigvee_{i<\lambda}\sigma(a_i;b;C).$$

Proof. We define recursively the required parameters a_i together with some auxiliary parameters b_i. The element a_n is chosen so that

3. $$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \sigma(a_n;b;C) \qquad \text{for every } b\in\mathcal{U}^z \text{ and every } C$$

and

4. $$\langle b_i,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \sigma(a_n;b_i;C) \qquad \text{for every } i<n \text{ and every } C.$$

This is possible because $\mathcal{D}$ is approximated from below. Note that (3) immediately guarantees (2). Now, assume (1) fails for $\lambda=n+1$, and choose b_n and C_n witnessing this. Then, by Fact 7, for some $\tilde{C}_{i,n}\cap C_n=\varnothing$

5. $$\langle b_n,C_n\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \quad\text{and}\quad \bigwedge_{i\le n}\sim\sigma(a_i;b_n;\tilde{C}_{i,n}).$$

Suppose for a contradiction that the construction carries on for κ stages. Then, as (5) guarantees that $\langle b_i,C_i\rangle\in\mathcal{D}$ for every i, from (4) we obtain $\sigma(a_n;b_i;C_i)$ for every $i<n$. From (5) we also obtain $\sim\sigma(a_i;b_n;\tilde{C}_{i,n})$, for every $i\le n$. Apply Ramsey with pairs $\langle C,\tilde{C}\rangle$ of compact subsets of S as colors to obtain a subsequence $\langle a'_i;b'_i : i<\kappa\rangle$ that contradicts Definition 20. □

28 Lemma Let $\sigma(x;z;X)$ be stable. Assume that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\sigma(x;z;X)$. Then for some $\lambda<\kappa$ the type

$$\pi(\bar{x};z;X) \;=\; \bigwedge_{i<\lambda}\sigma(x_i;z;X),$$

where the x_i are copies of x and $\bar{x}=\langle x_i : i<\lambda\rangle$, approximates $\mathcal{D}$ from below.

Proof. Negate the claim and let B witness that $\pi(\bar{x})$ does not approximate $\mathcal{D}$ from below. Suppose that $\langle a_i : i<n\rangle$ and $\langle b_i : i<n\rangle$ have been defined. Choose a_n such that for every $b\in B\cup\{b_i : i<n\}$ and every C

1. $$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \sigma(a_n;b;C) \quad\text{and}$$
2. $$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \sigma(a_n;b;C).$$

Note that the latter implication is equivalent to: for every C there is some $\tilde{C} \cap C = \varnothing$ such that

3. $$\langle b, C\rangle \notin \mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; {\sim}\sigma(a_n; b; \tilde{C}).$$

Now, as the lemma is assumed to fail, we can choose b_n and C_n such that

4. $$\langle b_n, C_n\rangle \notin \mathcal{D} \quad\text{and}\quad \bigwedge_{i=0}^{n} \sigma(a_i; b_n; C_n).$$

Note that (4) ensures that $\langle b_i, C_i\rangle \notin \mathcal{D}$ for every i. Then there is some $\tilde{C}_{i,n}$ that witnesses (3) for $\langle b_i, C_i\rangle \notin \mathcal{D}$. We claim that the procedure has to stop after $< \kappa$ steps. In fact, from (3) we obtain ${\sim}\sigma(a_n; b_i; \tilde{C}_{i,n})$ for every $i < n$. On the other hand, by (4) we have that $\sigma(a_i; b_n; C_n)$ for every $i < n$. Again, apply Ramsey with pairs $\langle C, \tilde{C}\rangle$ of compact subsets of S as colors to obtain a subsequence $\langle a'_i; b'_i \,:\, i < \kappa\rangle$ that contradicts Definition 20. □

29 Lemma If $\sigma(x; z; X)$ is stable, then $\pi(\bar{x}; z; X)$ in the previous lemma is stable.

Proof. Suppose $\pi(\bar{x}; z; X)$ is unstable. Let $\langle \bar{a}_i; b_i \,:\, i < \kappa\rangle$ be a sequence witnessing instability. Suppose ${\sim}\pi(\bar{a}_i; b_n; \tilde{C})$ holds for every $i < n < \kappa$ (the case $n < i < \kappa$ is identical). For every pair $i < n$ we can pick some $j < \lambda$ such that ${\sim}\sigma(a_{i,j}; b_n; \tilde{C})$. Interpret j as a color. As κ is a Ramsey cardinal, every λ-coloring of a complete graph of size κ has a monochromatic subgraph of size κ. That is, there is some fixed $j < \lambda$ such that ${\sim}\sigma(a_{i,j}; b_n; \tilde{C})$ holds for every pair $i < n$ restricted to range over a subsequence of length κ. Such a subsequence contradicts the stability of $\sigma(x; z; X)$. □

5. Yet another version of stability

In this section we present the notion of ε-stability and prove a version of Theorem 26 which, albeit approximate, only requires finite disjunctions and conjunctions.

In this section, the letter ε always denotes a compact symmetric neighborhood of the diagonal of S^2. If C is a subset of S, we write C^ε for the set of points that are ε-close to points in C. That is

$$C^\varepsilon \;=\; \{\alpha \in S \,:\, \langle \xi, \alpha\rangle \in \varepsilon \text{ for some } \xi \in C\}.$$

When C is a tuple, the definition above applies componentwise.

30 Definition Let $\varphi(x; z; X)$, for x and z tuples of variables of sort H, be an $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{X}}$-formula. We say that $\varphi(x; z; X)$ is ε-unstable if for every $m < \omega$ there is a sequence $\langle a_i; b_i; C_i; \tilde{C}_i \,:\, i < m\rangle$ such that for every $i < n < m$

$$\varphi(a_n; b_i; C_i) \;\wedge\; {\sim}\varphi(a_i; b_n; \tilde{C}_n) \quad\text{and}\quad C_i^\varepsilon \cap \tilde{C}_i = \varnothing.$$

A formula is ε-stable if it is not ε-unstable.

Note that the requirement of ε-stability is stronger the smaller the ε. It is also easy to see that ε-stable for every positive ε implies stable.

We state the main theorem of this section, which is proved along the same lines as Theorem 26.

31 Theorem Let $\varphi(x;z;X)$ be ε-stable. Assume that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\varphi(x;z;X)$. Then there are $k,m<\omega$ and $\langle a_{i,j} : i<k,\ j<m\rangle$ such that for every $b\in\mathcal{U}^z$ and every C

1. $$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \bigvee_{i<k}\bigwedge_{j<m}\varphi(a_{i,j};b;C^\varepsilon)$$
2. $$\langle b,C^\varepsilon\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \bigvee_{i<k}\bigwedge_{j<m}\varphi(a_{i,j};b;C).$$

Proof. The theorem is an immediate consequence of the following three lemmas. □

We need the following version of Definition 25.

32 Definition We say that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\varphi(x;z;X)$ from ε-below if for every finite $B\subseteq\mathcal{U}^z$ there is an $a\in\mathcal{U}^x$ such that for every C

1. $$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \varphi(a;b;C) \qquad \text{for every } b\in B \text{ and}$$
2. $$\langle b,C^\varepsilon\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \varphi(a;b;C) \qquad \text{for every } b\in\mathcal{U}^z.$$

33 Lemma Let $\varphi(x;z;X)$ be ε-stable. Assume that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\varphi(x;z;X)$ from ε-below. Then there are $k<\omega$ and $\langle a_i : i<k\rangle$ such that for every $b\in\mathcal{U}^z$ and every C

1. $$\langle b,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \bigvee_{i<k}\varphi(a_i;b;C^\varepsilon)$$
2. $$\langle b,C^\varepsilon\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \bigvee_{i<k}\varphi(a_i;b;C).$$

The proof is entirely similar to that of Lemma 27. It is nevertheless included to show the role of C^ε.

Proof. We define recursively the required parameters a_i together with some auxiliary parameters b_i. The element a_n is chosen so that

3. $$\langle b,C^\varepsilon\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \varphi(a_n;b;C) \qquad \text{for every } b\in\mathcal{U}^z \text{ and every } C$$

and

4. $$\langle b_i,C\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \varphi(a_n;b_i;C) \qquad \text{for every } i<n \text{ and every } C.$$

This is possible because $\mathcal{D}$ is approximated from ε-below. Note that (3) immediately guarantees (2). Now, assume (1) fails for $k=n+1$, and choose b_n and C_n witnessing this. Then, by Fact 7, for some $\tilde{C}_{i,n}\cap C_n^\varepsilon=\varnothing$

5. $$\langle b_n,C_n\rangle\in\mathcal{D} \quad\text{and}\quad \bigwedge_{i\le n}\sim\varphi(a_i;b_n;\tilde{C}_{i,n}).$$

Let m witness the ε-stability of $\varphi(x;z;X)$. Suppose for a contradiction that the construction carries on for m stages. Then, as (5) guarantees that $\langle b_i,C_i\rangle\in\mathcal{D}$ for every i, from (4)

we obtain $\varphi(a_n; b_i; C_i)$ for every $i < n < m$. From (5) we also obtain, for every $i < n < m$, some $\tilde{C}_{i,n} \cap C_n^\varepsilon = \varnothing$ such that $\sim\varphi(a_i; b_n; \tilde{C}_{i,n})$. By monotonicity, $\sim\varphi(a_i; b_n; \tilde{C}_n)$ for $\tilde{C}_n = \bigcup_{i<m} \tilde{C}_{i,n}$. This contradicts our choice of m. □

34 Lemma Let $\varphi(x; z; X)$ be ε-stable. Assume that $\mathcal{D}$ is approximable by $\varphi(x; z; X)$. Let m be maximal such that a sequence as in Definition 30 exists for $\varphi(x; z; X)$. Write $\bar{x}$ for $\langle x_i : i < m\rangle$, where the x_i are copies of x. Then the formula

$$\sigma(\bar{x}; z; X) \quad = \quad \bigwedge_{i<m} \varphi(x_i; z; X)$$

approximates $\mathcal{D}$ from ε-below.

Proof. Negate the claim and let B witness that $\sigma(\bar{x})$ does not approximate $\mathcal{D}$ from ε-below. For $n \le m$ suppose that $a_0, \ldots, a_{n-1}$ and $b_0, \ldots, b_{n-1}$ have been defined. Choose a_n such that for every $b \in B \cup \{b_0, \ldots, b_{n-1}\}$ and every C

1. $$\langle b, C\rangle \in \mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \varphi(a_n; b; C) \quad \text{and}$$
2. $$\langle b, C^\varepsilon\rangle \in \mathcal{D} \;\Leftarrow\; \varphi(a_n; b; C^\varepsilon).$$

Note that the second implication is equivalent to: for every C there is some $\tilde{C} \cap C^\varepsilon = \varnothing$ such that

3. $$\langle b, C^\varepsilon\rangle \notin \mathcal{D} \;\Rightarrow\; \sim\varphi(a_n; b; \tilde{C}).$$

Now, as the lemma is assumed to fail, we can choose b_n and C_n such that

4. $$\langle b_n, C_n^\varepsilon\rangle \notin \mathcal{D} \quad \text{and} \quad \bigwedge_{i=0}^{n} \varphi(a_i; b_n; C_n).$$

Note that (4) ensures that $\langle b_i, C_i^\varepsilon\rangle \notin \mathcal{D}$ for every i. Then there is some $\tilde{C}_{i,n} \cap C_i^\varepsilon = \varnothing$ that witnesses (3) for $\langle b_i, C_i^\varepsilon\rangle \notin \mathcal{D}$. We claim that the procedure has to stop at some stage $< m$. Assume for a contradiction that we can continue till we have $\langle a_i; b_i; C_i; \tilde{C}_i : i \le m\rangle$. From (3) we obtain $\sim\varphi(a_n; b_i; \tilde{C}_{i,n})$ for every $i < n \le m$. Therefore, by monotonicity, $\sim\varphi(a_n; b_i; \tilde{C}_i)$ for $\tilde{C}_i = \bigcup_{n\le m} \tilde{C}_{i,n}$. On the other hand, by (4) we have that $\varphi(a_i; b_n; C_n)$ for every $i < n \le m$. Therefore $\langle a_{m-i}; b_{m-i}; C_{m-i}; \tilde{C}_{m-i} : i \le m\rangle$ contradicts the maximality of m. □

35 Lemma If $\varphi(x; z; X)$ is ε-stable then $\sigma(\bar{x}; z; X)$ in the previous lemma is ε-stable.

Proof. Let m be maximal such that a sequence as in Definition 30 exists for $\varphi(x; z; X)$. Let k be sufficiently large so that every m-coloring of a graph of size k has a monocromatic subgraph of size $> m$. Let $\langle \bar{a}_i; b_i; C_i; \tilde{C}_i : i < k\rangle$ be a sequence witnessing the ε-instability of $\sigma(\bar{x}; z; X)$. Then for every pair $i < n$ there is some $j < m$ such that $\sim\varphi(a_{i,j}; b_n; \tilde{C}_n)$. By the choice of k there is a subsequence of length $> m$ and a fixed $j < m$ such that $\sim\varphi(a_{i,j}; b_n; \tilde{C}_n)$ holds for every pair $i < n$ in the subsequence. This contradicts the maximality of m. □

6. Stable definable functions

In this section we specialize the notions introduced in the previous sections to types $\sigma(x;z;X)$ of the form $\tau(x;z) \in X$, where $\tau(x;z)$ is an S-valued $\mathcal{F}$-type-definable function.

We say that $\tau(x;z)$ is stable or ε-stable if so is the type $\tau(x;z) \in X$. The following fact is an interesting characterization of stability for functions which was first remarked in [B].

36 Fact Let S be a compact metric space. Let $\tau(x;z)$ be a term in $\mathcal{L}$. Then the following are equivalent

1. the formula $\tau(x;z) \in X$ is unstable
2. there is a sequence $\langle a_i;b_i \,:\, i<\omega\rangle$ such that the two limits below exist and
$$\lim_{i\to\infty}\lim_{j\to\infty}\tau(a_i;b_j) \quad\neq\quad \lim_{j\to\infty}\lim_{i\to\infty}\tau(a_i;b_j).$$

Terms are a specific kind of definable functions. When $\tau(x;z)$ is a term, we have that $\sim\big(\tau(x;z)\in X\big) = \tau(x;z)\in X$, which is used throughout the proof below. We suspect that Fact 36 holds more generally when $\tau(x;z)$ is an S-valued $\mathcal{F}$-type-definable function, but we have not been able to prove this.

Proof. 1⇒2. Let $C\cap\tilde{C}=\varnothing$ and $\langle a_i;b_i \,:\, i<\omega\rangle$ be as given by (1). That is, $\tau(a_i;b_j)\in C$ and $\tau(a_j;b_i)\in\tilde{C}$ hold for every $i<j<\omega$. We can find a subsequence such that the two limits exist; C contains the limit on the left; and $\tilde{C}$ contains the limit on the right – which therefore are distinct.

2⇒1. Let C and $\tilde{C}$ be disjoint neighborhoods of the two limits in (2). Then (1) is witnessed by a tail of the sequence $\langle a_i;b_i \,:\, i<\omega\rangle$. □

Let $f:\mathcal{U}^z\to S$ be a function. We define
$$\mathcal{D}_f \quad=\quad \big\{\langle b,C\rangle \,:\, f(b)\in C,\ \ b\in\mathcal{U}^z,\ \ C\in K(S)\big\}.$$
The following fact is immediate.

37 Fact The following are equivalent

1. $\mathcal{D}_f$ is approximable by $\tau(x;z)\in X$
2. for every small $B\subseteq\mathcal{U}^z$ there is an $a\in\mathcal{U}^x$ such that $\tau(a;b)=f(b)$ for every $b\in B$.

We say that f is approximable by $\tau(x;z)$ if the equivalent conditions above hold. The following is an easy consequence of Theorem 26 and Theorem 31.

38 Theorem Let $S = [0,1]$. Let $\tau(x;z)$ be a term and let f be approximable by $\tau(x;z)$.

1. If $\tau(x;z)$ is stable, then there are λ and $\langle a_{i,j} : i,j < \lambda\rangle$ such that for every $b \in \mathcal{U}^z$
$$\sup_{i<\lambda} \inf_{j<\lambda} \tau(a_{i,j};b) = f(b).$$
2. If $\tau(x;z)$ is ε-stable there are m and $\langle a_{i,j} : i,j < m\rangle$ such that for every $b \in \mathcal{U}^z$
$$\left| f(b) - \max_{i<m} \min_{j<m} \tau(a_{i,j};b) \right| \leq \varepsilon.$$

From the proof it is clear that the matrix $a_{i,j}$ is such that $\sup_i \inf_j$ can be replaced by $\inf_i \sup_j$. Similarly, $\max_i \min_j$ can be replaced by $\min_i \max_j$.

Proof. We prove the first claim. Let λ and $\langle a_{i,j} : i,j < \lambda\rangle$ be as in Theorem 26. Let C_i be the closure of the set $\{\tau(a_{i,j};b) : j < \lambda\}$. By ($\Leftarrow$) in Theorem 26, $f(b) \in C_i$ for every $i < \lambda$. Then $f(b) \geq \inf_j \tau(a_{i,j};b)$ for every $i < \lambda$. Therefore $f(b) \geq \sup_i \inf_j \tau(a_{i,j};b)$.

Now, by ($\Rightarrow$) in Theorem 26 there is $k < \lambda$ such that $f(b) = \tau(a_{k,j};b)$ for every $j < \lambda$. Therefore $f(b) = \inf_j \tau(a_{k,j}\, b)$. Then $f(b) \leq \sup_i \inf_j \tau(a_{i,j}\, b)$.

We prove the second claim. Let m and $\langle a_{i,j} : i,j < m\rangle$ be as in Theorem 31 (without loss of generality $k = m$). Then Theorem 31 gives

3. $$\bigvee_{i<m} \bigwedge_{j<m} \left|\tau(a_{i,j};b) - f(b)\right| \leq \varepsilon.$$

We claim that we also have

4. $$\bigwedge_{i<m} \bigvee_{j<m} \left|\tau(a_{i,j};b) - f(b)\right| \leq \varepsilon.$$

For $i < m$, let $C_i = \{\tau(a_{i,j};b) : j < m\}$. Then
$$\bigwedge_{j<m} \tau(a_{i,j};b) \in C_i,$$
hence by Theorem 31 (2) there is k such that
$$\left|\tau(a_{i,k};b) - f(b)\right| \leq \varepsilon.$$
Then (4) follows.

Now, suppose (2) of the theorem fails for the given ε. Then for some $b \in \mathcal{U}^z$ one of the following obtains

5. $$f(b) - \min_{j<m} \tau(a_{i,j};b) > \varepsilon \qquad \text{for every } i < m$$

6. $$\min_{j<m} \tau(a_{i,j};b) - f(b) > \varepsilon \qquad \text{for some } i < m.$$

But (5) contradicts (3), while (6) contradicts (4). □

Acknowledgments Domenico Zambella would like to thank Elisabetta Marchese for helpful discussion.

Author contribution All authors have contributed equally.

Funding Silvia Barbina was partially supported by PRIN2022 *Models, sets and classifications*, prot. 2022TECZJA. Riccardo Camerlo was partially supported by the MUR excellence department project awarded to the Department of Mathematics of the University of Genoa, CUP D33C23001110001. Domenico Zambella was partially supported by PRIN2022 *Logical methods in combinatorics*, prot. 2022BXH4R5

Conflict of interest The authors declare no conflict of interest.

References

[ABBMZ] Claudio Agostini, Stefano Baratella, Silvia Barbina, Luca Motto Ros, and Domenico Zambella, *Continuous logic in a classical setting*, Bull. Iran. Math. Soc. **51** (2025). arXiv:2402.01245.

[B] Itaï Ben Yaacov, *Model theoretic stability and definability of types, after A. Grothendieck*, Bull. Symb. Log. **20** (2014), no. 4, 491–496. arXiv:1306.5852.

[BBHU] Itaï Ben Yaacov, Alexander Berenstein, C. Ward Henson, and Alexander Usvyatsov, *Model theory for metric structures*, Model theory with applications to algebra and analysis. Vol. 2, London Math. Soc. Lecture Note Ser., vol. 350, Cambridge Univ. Press, Cambridge, 2008, pp. 315–427.

[BU] Itaï Ben Yaacov and Alexander Usvyatsov, *Continuous first order logic and local stability*, Trans. Amer. Math. Soc. **362** (2010), 5213–5259. arXiv:0801.4303.

[CH] Alexis Chevalier and Ehud Hrushovski, *Piecewise Interpretable Hilbert Spaces* (2023). arXiv:2110.05142.

[CP] Nicolas Chavarria and Anand Pillay, *On pp-elimination and stability in a continuous setting*, Ann. Pure Appl. Logic **174** (2023), 1–14. arXiv:2107.14329.

[CS] Artem Chernikov and Pierre Simon, *Externally definable sets and dependent pairs*, Israel J. Math. **194** (2013), no. 1, 409–425. arXiv:1007.4468.

[HI] C. Ward Henson and José Iovino, *Ultraproducts in analysis*, Analysis and logic (Mons, 1997), London Math. Soc. Lecture Note Ser., vol. 262, Cambridge Univ. Press, Cambridge, 2002, pp. 1–110.

[I] José Iovino, *Applications of model theory to functional analysis*, Dover Publications, Inc., Mineola, NY, 2014.

[TZ] Katrin Tent and Martin Ziegler, *A course in model theory*, Lecture Notes in Logic, vol. 40, Association for Symbolic Logic, La Jolla, CA; Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 2012.

[Z15] Domenico Zambella, *Elementary classes of finite VC-dimension*, Arch. Math. Logic (2015), 511–520. arXiv:1412.5781.

[Z] _____, *Standard analysis* (2023). arXiv:2311.15711.

[Z?] _____, *Crèche course in model theory* (2025). Course notes.

Silvia Barbina SEZIONE DI MATEMATICA, UNIVERSITÀ DI CAMERINO

Email address,: silvia.barbina@unicam.it

Riccardo Camerlo DIPARTIMENTO DI MATEMATICA, UNIVERSITÀ DI GENOVA

Email address,: riccardo.camerlo@unige.it

Domenico Zambella DIPARTIMENTO DI MATEMATICA, UNIVERSITÀ DI TORINO

Email address,: domenico.zambella@unito.it